FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17020

Issue Title : Assigning Cycles to Life Limited Landing Gear Components When Traceability Cannot Be Confirmed

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3200-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
767, 737, 757, 737NG, 747	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/11/2017	05/11/2017	04/18/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes

Description

This FTD article discusses the thought process behind assigning a theoretic (conservative) cycle value to a life limited component when full traceability/history has not been maintained.

Background

There are several potential methods of assigning total cycles on life limited landing gear components, when the previous history is not recorded. The objective is to assign flight cycles (at a point in time) based on a high time airplane (of a fleet, or fleet segment), and then track the accumulated flight cycles on that component from that point in time.

Assign the high time flight cycles from the model specific (e.g. 737) fleet leader, or the high time of an operator's model specific fleet leader (if the gear components have been within that operators fleet - only - and have not been obtained from another operator or MRO). This is often possible when an operator overhauls their own components, and their gear components are not interchanged with any other airline (whose gear they may overhaul).

A second option would be to use the maximum cycles in a segment of airplanes (for instance, if an operator knew that the components came from a particular operator's fleet of airplanes). The high time aircraft in that operator's fleet would be used.

If the component can only be used on a specific minor model (e.g. 737-600/700), an operator can further limit the possibilities (thus reducing the high time cycles used as base for establishing current flight cycles).

Consider assigning the total cycles from the airplane at the time the component is removed from an airplane for the first time.

Any portion of a fleet, which has never had the gear removed for overhaul, would not normally be included in such approximations (because the total flight cycles on the airplane, and thus the gear, are known). For instance, on an airplane with 1200 flight cycles, an operator would loose (economically) if a total fleet flight cycles of 45,000 was assigned.

An operator would benefit by grouping gear components into at least two groups:

BOEING PROPRIETARY - The information contained herein is Proprietary to The Boeing Company and shall not be reproduced or disclosed in whole or in part or used for any reason except when such user possesses direct, written authorization from The Boeing Company. Encrypted emails required for forwarding via Email.The document generated on 11/08/2026 by Fleet Team Digest application via MyBoeingFleet. This document is for reference purposes only, visit the application for all the latest and updated revisions of this document.

Copyright ©2026 Boeing. All rights reserved.

EXPORT CONTROLLED -This technology or software is subject to the U.S. Export Administration Regulations (EAR), (15 C.F.R. Parts 730-774). No authorization from the U.S. Department of Commerce is required for export, re-export, in-country transfer, or access EXCEPT to country group E:1 or E:2 countries/persons per Supp.1 to Part 740 of the EAR. ECCN : 9E991

- Those which have not been through overhaul. These items can be assigned total actual aircraft cycles accumulated to date, at removal for first overhaul.

- Those which have been through overhaul, and possibly interchanged with other airplanes. These items would be candidates for assigning total cycles based on logic similar to that described above.

- It also appears that an operator could further group some components that have been through only one overhaul at a certain date. The portion of the fleet that have these components might be narrowed further than that which would include all airplanes in the fleet, which would avoid penalties to airplanes delivered at a later date.

For instance:

1. Those components which have not been overhauled to date (serialize and assign actual cycles at the first overhaul).

2. Those components which have been overhauled once to date

3. Those components which have been overhauled more than once

In any of the above, the initial total cycles is assigned to a component. After that time, the actual flight cycles are tracked for each component, and provided during gear exchange (or gear removal).

Note:

Any assumption used above may need to be coordinated, and approved for use, with an operator's local regulatory agency.

Status

This FTD article describes a theoretical method to conservatively assign cycles to a component when traceability history has not been maintained or has been lost. No changes to this method are expected.

Interim Action

None expected.

Final Action

None.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-32-105		

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

BOEING PROPRIETARY - The information contained herein is Proprietary to The Boeing Company and shall not be reproduced or disclosed in whole or in part or used for any reason except when such user possesses direct, written authorization from The Boeing Company. Encrypted emails required for forwarding via Email.The document generated on 11/08/2026 by Fleet Team Digest application via MyBoeingFleet. This document is for reference purposes only, visit the application for all the latest and updated revisions of this document.

Copyright ©2026 Boeing. All rights reserved.

EXPORT CONTROLLED -This technology or software is subject to the U.S. Export Administration Regulations (EAR), (15 C.F.R. Parts 730-774). No authorization from the U.S. Department of Commerce is required for export, re-export, in-country transfer, or access EXCEPT to country group E:1 or E:2 countries/persons per Supp.1 to Part 740 of the EAR. ECCN : 9E991

FLEET TEAM DIGEST

BOEING PROPRIETARY - The information contained herein is Proprietary to The Boeing Company and shall not be reproduced or disclosed in whole or in part or used for any reason except when such user possesses direct, written authorization from The Boeing Company. Encrypted emails required for forwarding via Email.The document generated on 11/08/2026 by Fleet Team Digest application via MyBoeingFleet. This document is for reference purposes only, visit the application for all the latest and updated revisions of this document.

Copyright ©2026 Boeing. All rights reserved.

EXPORT CONTROLLED -This technology or software is subject to the U.S. Export Administration Regulations (EAR), (15 C.F.R. Parts 730-774). No authorization from the U.S. Department of Commerce is required for export, re-export, in-country transfer, or access EXCEPT to country group E:1 or E:2 countries/persons per Supp.1 to Part 740 of the EAR. ECCN : 9E991